Checkpoint 2 · Empathy Research & Field Inquiry

8 Full User Interviews, AEIOU Observations, Empathy Maps & Stakeholder Analysis | INT335

1. Field Research Methodology & Sampling Rationale

To develop deep human empathy for campus lost-and-found dynamics, Team 15 conducted 8 semi-structured qualitative interviews spanning two distinct user cohorts: (1) Students who experienced loss or discovered items across academic blocks, and (2) Frontline campus caretakers (Senior Security Guard Gurpreet Singh at Block 34 and Central Library Circulation Supervisor Manjit Kumar). Observation sessions were structured using the formal AEIOU framework across 3 primary campus nodes at peak transition hours (12:45 PM and 5:00 PM).

2. Participant Cohort Registry & Verification Table

Code	Participant Name	Campus Role	Field Site	Date	Lost / Found Experience	Consent
S1	**Rohan Verma** (12503412)	Hosteller (2nd Yr CSE)	Central Library	14/09/26	Casio fx-991EX calculator	[X] Signed
S2	**Simranjeet Kaur** (12504891)	Fresher (1st Yr CSE)	Block 34 Lobby	15/09/26	LPU RFID Smart ID card	[X] Signed
S3	**Aman Sharma** (12506214)	Day Scholar (3rd Yr Mech)	UniMall Food Court	16/09/26	Bike keys with red lanyard	[X] Signed
S4	**Neha Reddy** (12507845)	Day Scholar (2nd Yr ECE)	Block 36 Corridor	18/09/26	Leather wallet & bus pass	[X] Signed
S5	**Sahil Gupta** (12501290)	Commuter (4th Yr CSE)	Parking Lot 2	19/09/26	Laptop charger & bus pass	[X] Signed
S6	**Divya Nair** (12509112)	Hosteller (1st Yr MBA)	Central Library	20/09/26	Milton steel water bottle	[X] Signed
G1	**Officer Gurpreet Singh**	Senior Security Guard	Block 34 Gate Post	21/09/26	6 unindexed black umbrellas	[X] Verified
G2	**Staff Manjit Kumar**	Circulation Supervisor	Central Library Desk	22/09/26	Unclaimed exam calculators	[X] Verified

3. Deep Interview Records & Qualitative Transcripts

Rohan Verma (Hosteller, 2nd Year B.Tech CSE · BH-4) — *Incident: Lost Casio fx-991EX calculator 2 days before Engineering Mathematics Mid-Term.*

"I was studying in Central Library reading hall until 9:00 PM. The next morning in class, I opened my bag and my calculator was gone. In panic, I posted in 4 different unofficial LPU WhatsApp groups and on an Instagram confession handle. Within an hour, two random individuals messaged me claiming they had found it, but when I asked for a photo, they demanded a ■200 UPI transfer first. Another person claimed to be the owner when a friend tried posting a found photo. Because the photo showed the front keypad, anyone could pretend it belonged to them."

Empathy Takeaway: Key Insight: Open social media broadcasts enable opportunistic fraud; rightful owners need private proof verification (like scratched initials or serial numbers) that is hidden from public view.

Simranjeet Kaur (Fresher Hosteller, 1st Year B.Tech · GH-2) — *Incident: Lost LPU RFID Smart Card during orientation week in Block 34.*

"During freshers week, I slipped my ID into my jacket pocket while rushing to my physics lecture. When I reached the hostel mess for dinner, the turnstile rejected me because I didn't have my card. I couldn't eat at the mess, borrow books, or enter the hostel after curfew without paying a daily fine or pleading with the warden. Every security guard asked me for proof of identity, but my only identity card was the very thing I had lost! Replacement takes 5 working days."

Empathy Takeaway: Key Insight: Identity card loss triggers immediate administrative paralysis, cutting students off from nutrition and housing access.

Aman Sharma (Day Scholar, 3rd Year B.Tech Mechanical) — *Incident: Discovered motorcycle keys with a red lanyard on UniMall food court staircase.*

"I found bike keys sitting on the railing near the food court stairs. I picked them up, but my lab in Block 38 was starting in 6 minutes. I didn't know whether to walk 800 meters to the main gate security, leave them with a shopkeeper, or hand them to the nearest cleaner. I didn't want to carry them home to Jalandhar because the owner would be stranded on campus after classes. I ended up leaving them on the fast-food counter, feeling guilty that they would be stolen."

Empathy Takeaway: Key Insight: Finders are naturally empathetic but severely time-constrained; reporting an item must take less than 60 seconds on a phone.

Officer Gurpreet Singh (Senior Campus Security Officer, Block 34 Gate) — *Incident: Managing physical lost-and-found cardboard box at central entrance desk.*

"Students drop off items almost daily—water bottles, earphones, notebooks, and umbrellas. Right now under my desk, I have a cardboard box with 6 black umbrellas, 4 scientific calculators, and dozens of keys. When a student comes asking 'Did anyone find my black umbrella?', what am I supposed to do? They all look identical. I cannot give state or student property away without proof. If students had a verified digital claim token showing unique markings, I could release items in 10 seconds with total accountability."

Empathy Takeaway: Key Insight: Frontline security staff are overwhelmed by identical items and require objective, secret proof verification to safely release items.

4. AEIOU Observational Field Study

Dimension	Observed Field Evidence on LPU Campus	Human-Centered Design Implication
Activities	Students hurriedly re-checking desks, asking friends, scrolling WhatsApp groups, approaching hesitant gate guards during 10-minute intervals.	Reporting and claiming must require zero physical travel and take < 60 seconds on mobile.
Environments	Massive 600-acre campus with disparate nodes (Library, UniMall, Block 34). Distances exceed 1.5 km between academic hubs.	Decentralized digital tagging by block, floor, and room number eliminates physical cross-campus walking.
Interactions	Anxious interrogations at security posts; students feeling judged; awkward bargaining with unverified claimants on Instagram.	Automated anonymous matching with mediated physical security handovers preserves student dignity.
Objects	High-stakes items: Casio scientific calculators (■1,500), RFID cards (access gate), AirPods, smartwatches, umbrellas.	Pre-configured academic categories with specific trait dropdowns (color, brand, secret scratch proof).
Users	Stressed hostellers, commuting day scholars on bus schedules, multi-lingual campus security staff (Hindi, Punjabi, Telugu).	Complete 7-language UI localization so security guards can effortlessly verify claims in Punjabi/Hindi.

5. Synthesized Empathy Map & Stakeholder Matrix

SAYS (Verbatim Quotes) • "I posted my number and got 15 creepy spam calls." • "Will someone really turn in a Casio calculator?" • "Guards rotate shifts so no one knows who took my bag yesterday."	**THINKS (Internal Beliefs & Doubts)** • "If I post publicly, people will think I am careless." • "Whoever picked it up will probably keep it for themselves." • "Security won't believe it's mine without an official receipt."
DOES (Observed Behaviors) • Reluctantly posts on unmoderated social media pages. • Walks 2 km in heat between Block 34 and Library. • Gives up hope after 48 hours and buys an expensive replacement.	**FEELS (Emotional Reality)** • Anxious before midterm exams without necessary tools. • Vulnerable to fraud and privacy exposure. • Helpless due to campus scale and lack of communication.